Benchmark reference answer

Question	How much money are asylum seekers given to live on?
Essential The very minimum an answer needs to include. Comprises: • Any accurate answer to what the user asked for. • What the user needs to know in order to avoid being misled.	The cash support for asylum seekers is £9.95 per person per week if the asylum seeker's accommodation provides meals, and £49.18 per person per week if not.
Good answer If the bare essentials aren't enough to meet an "average" user's needs. Comprises: • Information that further answers the user's question, but that goes beyond what is strictly "essential" *This section is **optional** and is unnecessary for basic questions.*	• Pregnant women and mothers of children aged 1 to 3 receive an extra £5.25 a week, and mothers with a baby under 1 receive an additional £9.50 a week • Mothers can also apply for a one-off maternity grant of £300 if a baby is due in 11 weeks or less, or if the baby is under 6 months old • Cash support above available while appealing a rejected asylum claim • Asylum support above usually ends 42 days (6 weeks) after someone is granted refugee status • Under a new law, asylum seekers who can afford to do so may be required to pay £10,000 towards the cost of their accommodation and support
Background Core facts relevant to the question — use as a reference guide for annotators.	Asylum support • People who have an active asylum case and are considered destitute (they are homeless or do not have enough money to buy food) can apply for specific asylum support from the government - somewhere to live, a cash allowance, or both. • Asylum seekers can't access mainstream benefits like Universal Credit Subsistence support under Section 95 of Immigration and Asylum Act • The money is loaded onto a prepaid debit card (ASPEN) card each week Other situations • Asylum seekers who don't receive asylum support may still get free prescriptions in England due to other rules - e.g. they may be pregnant or eligible due to their age. Prescriptions are free for everyone in Scotland and Northern Ireland, and free in Wales for those registered with a GP • Asylum seekers whose claims have been rejected can apply for Section 4 or short term support, if they are homeless, don't have money to buy food and if there's a good reason they can't yet leave the UK (though they won't be given the payment card without housing) • Asylum seekers are generally not permitted to work